



Poke-man dead

Takeshi Shudo, Writer/Creator of Pokemon, the Japanese cartoon series, passes away at 61

Twitter down?

Twitter's CEO, Evan Williams, steps down to concentrate on product strategy

Who do you trust?

This month, we conclude Icons of Trust 2010. For the remaining categories, read Part 1 in last month's issue...

Team Digit

With valuable feedback from our readers
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Desktop PC

Whether it be printers, wireless devices, or storage, inevitably it's a desktop or a notebook they are being connected to / used with. Desktop penetration in India is low, but compared to what it was five years back we've come a long way. One of the most important things to remember when talking about a desktop is that, it's a combination of components with added after sales support and warranties from a single brand.

Market trends

Desktops have continued their downward spiral in terms of pricing. Desktop trends are pretty much tied with hardware trends. This year has also seen Intel's entry level Core i5 and Core

i3 processors pervade desktops. This has brought the goodness of greater processing power to the masses. Today, a desktop is largely an affordable commodity, and with entry-level desktops starting at ₹12,000, there's no reason why you cannot afford one and introduce yourself and your loved ones to the world of information technology and progress.



Perceptions from our survey

1. Assembled computers have gained reputation. When collectively viewed as a brand, assembled PCs garner a lot of trust and they are just a few points behind Dell – the leader in this regard. Incidentally, Apple blows HP out of the water when it comes to consumer opinions on trust. 35 per cent people trust Apple over HP and Dell.
2. Apple desktops were also voted the most rugged. Dell and assembled desktops take second and third spots.
3. Dell was voted the most innovative trailed closely by Apple. However, Apple was voted the most technologically advanced with an additional eight per cent people strongly agreeing with this.
4. Apple makes stylish products – we have to agree, and so does our audience. In fact, Apple garners the most votes under “strongly agree”. Dell is a close second, followed by HP/Compaq.
5. When talking about market availability, HP/Compaq wins hands down among the brands. Only assembled desktops were voted as being easier to buy than HP. We feel this is due to HP's strong presence in the distribution channel, where as a larger brand leveraging of ones product is possible. Strong presence in the retail segment is also a plus. Dell is a distant third here.
6. Our readers feel Dell and Apple are nearly equally credible, with a points advantage going to Dell. HP/Compaq garners the same amount of credibility as assembled PCs – a good showing for assembled systems that have traditionally lost out on the factor. Lenovo is a distant fifth in this comparison.
7. More HP and Dell users are satisfied with their desktops than any other brand or assembled computers. Talk about loyalty, and Dell is number one, followed by Apple.
8. Surprisingly, (and we're pleased

HOW WE TRUSTED

How is trust calculated?

All respondents are asked to complete a rather long and comprehensive questionnaire, which aims at arriving at scores for five parameters.

Awareness: Purchases depend a lot on your awareness and the market's awareness of a brand. To get figures for awareness, we asked the respondents some questions to see how many knew of the brands in this segment. This is again sub-divided into first, unaided recall, such as, “Which is the first brand that comes to mind”, and “What other brands are you aware of”; later, we provided people with a list to measure aided recall.

Credibility: Under this, questions were asked to gauge what respondents felt about the quality, durability, technological advancement, design, innovativeness, etc., of each brand. This is by far the biggest contributor to the overall trust index, weighing in at 40 per cent.

Satisfaction: As owners of a brand's products, how satisfied you are with their products is one of the key factors

that influence how much you trust the brand. In this regard, we questioned the respondents on general satisfaction, information available on it, after-sales support etc. This was the second biggest factor in determining overall trust.

Loyalty: A brand's ability to create fanboys speaks a lot. To ascertain the loyalty that respondents held for brands, we asked them a series of questions that ascertained whether they would buy another product from the same brand. We also gauged how eager the respondents were to recommend products from this brand to friends and relatives.

Cost of ownership: There's expenditure associated with products even after purchase for servicing and repair, which may or may not fall under the warranty period. To ascertain this, we asked the respondents a series of questions to determine how much they had spent on a brand after purchase. This factors in the warranty, repair costs, upgrading (if any), etc. We also asked which brands respondents felt were cheaper to own.